



FRANZ LISZT, 1838

The composer is captured here by Henri Lehmann in 1838, aged 27. Two years later, Liszt visited England; The Birmingham Journal reported: “He is a very good-looking young man ... with a fine forehead, good nose, and well-cut mouth, not a little resembling the portraits of Bonaparte ... He is plainly ... a man of great genius and originality.” The strong resemblance to Napoleon had not gone unnoticed by the young (married) women of the Paris salons who, by all accounts, were equally enthralled by the young man’s good looks and his musical genius.